EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



THE MAGIC SWAN GEESE

A Classic Folk Tale on Responsibility, Humility, and Winning Allies in Crisis

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Jupiter Group LLC

International Cataloging & Language Availability:
Jupiter, Zinaida (DBA). *THE MAGIC SWAN GEESE: Executive & Strategic 2×2 Decision Matrix Edition (Ages 12+).* — Book IX of XVI in the *Jupiter Wisdom Tales* Series.
Published originally in English for the global market, with official translations into **Russian**, **Mandarin Chinese**, and other world languages.
Publisher: **Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group" (Jupiter Group LLC)**, Reg. No. 217940-3310-OOO, TIN 01705202310085, 4 A. Borubaeva St., Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic.
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Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *THE MAGIC SWAN GEESE* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Connects classic woodland rescue folklore with the universal ethic of reciprocity, humility, and servant leadership.

Proverb of the Book: *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. THE PARENTS' CHARGE AND THE FORGOTTEN PROMISE ❧



Before leaving for the town fair, Father and Mother kissed their daughter Masha and said: 'Guard your little brother Vanya in the courtyard, dear—do not wander off!' They promised to bring her a bright kerchief and gingerbread.

Yet no sooner had the wagon disappeared down the road than Masha seated Vanya on the grass under the window and ran off to the end of the street to play games with her friends.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

❧ SHEET II. THE SHADOW OF THE SWAN GEESE AND THE PROUD REFUSALS ❧



Suddenly a flock of white Swan Geese swept down from the clouds, lifted little Vanya on their wide wings, and carried him toward the dark forest! Masha rushed after them in tears.

Along the road she met the glowing Stove, the heavy-laden Apple Tree, and the fragrant Milk River with its Kissel Banks. Each offered help if she tasted their humble fare—yet Masha tossed her head proudly: 'At my father's house we don't even eat wheat cakes, let alone plain rye pie or wild apples!'—and received no direction.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

❧ SHEET III. AWAKENING AT THE EDGE OF THE DEEP WOODS ❧



Reaching the forest hut where Vanya sat playing with silver apples, Masha realized that pride and excuses could never save her brother. A kind little Woodland Hedgehog showed her the way—and Masha's heart changed completely.

Gathering Vanya gently into her arms, she began the race home with the Swan Geese circling high overhead.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

❧ SHEET IV. HUMILITY AND CARE UNLOCK EVERY ALLY ON THE ROAD ❧



When the Swan Geese swooped down along the return path, Masha bowed respectfully to the Milk River and tasted its simple dish—and the river sheltered the children beneath its bank. At the Apple Tree she propped up the heavy branches and thanked it warmly—and the green boughs hid them from sight.

At the Stove she gratefully tasted the warm rye pie—and the Stove concealed them safely until the geese flew past.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

❧ SHEET V. SAFE IN MOTHER'S ARMS BEFORE SUNSET ❧



Just as Father and Mother's wagon rolled through the village gate with gifts, Masha and little Vanya stepped out onto the clean porch—safe, united, and wiser for life.

Thus the tale reveals a golden secret: when we own our mistakes immediately and treat every humble helper with respect, the whole world becomes our shield!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Haughty pride closes three doors on the road; a humble word and a helping hand turn every neighbour into a shield."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why didn't the Stove, the Apple Tree, and the River help Masha on the way there?**
  How did saying 'At my father's house we don't eat plain rye pie!' close three doors of help in a row?
- **2. What changed inside Masha on the way back?**
  Not only did she ask politely, she also helped prop up the Apple Tree's heavy branches and clear the stream. Why does care open every heart?
- **3. What should you do if you make a mistake at home?**
  Hide and blame others, or act immediately like Masha to fix it with courage and kindness?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *You promised to tidy the room or look after a pet, got distracted playing, and suddenly realize time is almost up and you need help from your family or friends.*

Path 1 (Hiding & Blaming Others): Pretend nothing happened and blame the pet or your sibling.

Path 2 ('At My Father's House!' Pride): Demand help rudely while looking down on simple advice.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (Masha on the Return Road!):
Take responsibility right away, speak with warmth and respect, help others in return, and finish the job together!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw the kind Apple Tree sheltering Masha and little Vanya beneath its golden-apple branches!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Play 'Masha's Fast Recovery': if something spills or is forgotten, zero scolding—everyone teams up to fix it in two minutes!

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY & ACTION → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: HUMILITY & RESPECT FOR ALLIES

Lesson II • Lonely Running in Pride
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Trying hard to fix a mistake alone while speaking arrogantly to everyone who could help.

★ SHIELD OF RESPONSIBILITY & KINDNESS
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
Immediate ownership of duty combined with sincere respect for every helper along the way.

Lesson I • Carelessness & Excuses
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Forgetting one's promise and then blaming everyone around when trouble strikes.

Lesson III • Polite Passivity
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Speaking sweetly to everyone, yet never taking bold action to rescue the matter.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Own your duty and fix mistakes immediately: Courage begins the second you stop making excuses and start acting.

2. Respect every honest helper and simple bread: Gratitude for small kindnesses builds a wall of friends around your family.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. Masha on the Outbound Road — Status Arrogance in Crisis:** A manager who misses an operational SLA and then alienates frontline vendors and support teams with elitist attitude.
- **2. Stove, Apple Tree & River — Frontline Ecosystem Partners:** Suppliers, regional contractors, IT support, and rank-and-file staff who hold the real operational keys during an emergency.
- **3. The Woodland Hedgehog — Ground-Level Navigator:** Modest field expert who sees the quiet backdoor solution when top executives are running in circles.
- **4. Masha on the Return Road — Extreme Ownership & Servant Leadership:** Takes 100% responsibility, drops status posturing, solves partner pain points ('clears the stream'), and brings the asset home.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Treating Suppliers and Frontline Teams With 'Wheat-Cake Snobbery': Saying 'We are a premier brand, we don't care about your small issues'—and discovering in a crisis that nobody will cover your flank.

Trap 2 — Wasting the Golden Hour of Incident Response on Blame: Looking for excuses when a critical project ('little Vanya') is carried off instead of mobilizing the field network immediately.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Extreme Ownership + Ecosystem Reciprocity: Own the breach in minute one, respect every link in the chain, and remove obstacles for your partners so they shield your business.

AXIS Y ↑: SPEED OF CRISIS OWNERSHIP & ACTION → | AXIS X ►: RESPECT & RECIPROCITY WITH ECOSYSTEM (CORPORATE SNOBBERY ('WHEAT CAKES') → SERVANT LEADERSHIP & MUTUAL AID)

Quadrant 2 • Arrogant Crisis Manager
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Works frantically during an outage, but burns bridges with vendors and staff through rudeness.

★ ECOSYSTEM RESCUE ALLIANCE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
Instant crisis ownership backed by deep respect and reciprocal support across all partners.

Quadrant 1 • Missed SLA & Arrogance
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Dropping the ball on core duty and alienating every potential helper on the road.

Quadrant 3 • Friendly But Slow
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Good relations with suppliers, yet zero urgency when a critical asset is at risk.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Eat the Stove's rye pie with respect!"	Drop corporate snobbery and accept the practical, simple solution offered by our field team or vendor.	**★ Approve the pragmatic field fix immediately.**
"Prop up the Apple Tree's branches first"	Before asking a partner for an emergency favour, help solve their bottleneck.	**★ Offer immediate operational or payment support to the key supplier.**
"Switch to Masha's return-road mode"	Stop analyzing why the mistake happened—focus 100% on bringing the project safely home before deadline.	**★ Launch the 24-hour recovery sprint.**
"Don't leave Vanya on the grass without a watch"	A mission-critical client or system was left unmonitored during a team distraction.	**★ Assign dedicated on-call ownership.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
Incident Response SLA (Golden Hour Protocol); Supply-Chain Reciprocity Covenants; Blameless Recovery Charter.

JUPITER WISDOM TALES • INTERNATIONAL COLLECTOR IMPRINT

THE MAGIC SWAN GEESE (Book IX of XVI)

Author & Series Creator: **Zinaida Jupiter, DBA**

Publisher & Copyright Holder: Limited Liability Company "Jupiter Group" (OsOO "Jupiter Group" / Jupiter Group LLC)
State Registration No.: 217940-3310-OOO • **TIN (INN):** 01705202310085 • **OKPO:** 31950675
Registering Authority: Osh Justice Department, Ministry of Justice of the Kyrgyz Republic
Registered Legal Address: 4 A. Borubaeva Street, Apt. 21, Osh, 723500, Kyrgyz Republic
Managing Director (CEO): Vladimir Yuryevich Jupiter
Languages: Published originally in English; officially translated into Russian, Mandarin Chinese, and global languages.
Official Website: https://jupiter-wisdom-tales.com • **E-mail:** info@jupiter-wisdom-tales.com